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Device and method for making aseptic connections

Abstract

The present invention provides devices and methods for establishing aseptic connections between two or more components or subassemblies. The devices may be used in medical devices such as drug delivery pumps (10). In some embodiments, a connection is made between a drug container (50, 1050, 2050) and a fluid pathway connection assembly (300, 1300, 2300). The fluid pathway connection assembly may include a connection hub (312, 1312, 2312), a piercing member (316, 1316, 2316), and a piercing member retainer (314, 1314, 2314). The assembly may further include a first film (318, 1318, 2318) covering a cavity (312A, 1312A, 2312A), thereby maintaining the aseptic condition of the cavity. The drug container may hold a fluid drug and include a pierceable seal (326, 1326, 2326). A second film (322, 1322, 2322) may cover a recess (328, 1328, 2328) formed by the seal and thereby maintain the aseptic condition of the interior of the chamber. The piercing member may be caused to pierce the first and second film and the pierceable seal to open a fluid pathway for delivery of the fluid drug through the fluid pathway connection assembly.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/552,828, filed Aug. 23, 2017, which is the U.S. National Stage of PCT/US2016/020486, filed Mar. 2, 2016, which claims the benefit of priority of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/148,082, filed Apr. 15, 2015 and U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/127,021, filed Mar. 2, 2015. The entirety of the foregoing is expressly incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD

(1) This invention relates to aseptic connections. More particularly, this invention relates to devices and methods for making aseptic connections in septic environments, thereby allowing components to be integrated into drug delivery devices.

BACKGROUND

(2) Parenteral delivery of various drugs, i.e., delivery by means other than through the digestive track, has become a desired method of drug delivery for a number of reasons. This form of drug delivery by injection may enhance the effect of the substance being delivered and ensure that the unaltered medicine reaches its intended site at a significant concentration. Similarly, undesired side effects associated with other routes of delivery, such as systemic toxicity, can potentially be avoided through parenteral delivery. By bypassing the digestive system of a mammalian patient, one can avoid degradation of the active ingredients caused by the catalytic enzymes in the digestive tract and liver and ensure that a necessary amount of drug, at a desired concentration, reaches the targeted site.

(3) Traditionally, manually operated syringes and injection pens have been employed for delivering parenteral drugs to a patient. More recently, parenteral delivery of liquid medicines into the body has been accomplished by administering bolus injections using a needle and reservoir, continuously by gravity driven dispensers, or via transdermal patch technologies. Bolus injections can imperfectly match the clinical needs of the patient, and may require larger individual doses than are desired at the specific time they are given. Continuous delivery of medicine through gravity-feed systems compromises the patient's mobility and lifestyle, and limits the therapy to simplistic flow rates and profiles. Another form of drug delivery, transdermal patches, similarly has its restrictions. Transdermal patches often require specific molecular drug structures for efficacy, and the control of the drug administration through a transdermal patch is severely limited.

(4) Ambulatory infusion pumps have been developed for delivering liquid medicaments to a patient. These infusion devices have the ability to offer sophisticated fluid delivery profiles accomplishing bolus requirements, continuous infusion and variable rate delivery. These infusion capabilities usually result in better efficacy of the drug and therapy and less toxicity to the patient's system. Currently available ambulatory infusion devices are expensive, difficult to program and prepare for infusion, and tend to be bulky, heavy and very fragile. Filling these devices can be difficult and require the patient to carry both the intended medication as well as filling accessories. The devices often require specialized care, maintenance, and cleaning to assure proper functionality and safety for their intended long-term use, and are not cost-effective for patients and healthcare providers.

(5) As compared to syringes and injection pens, pump type delivery devices can be significantly more convenient to a patient, in that doses of the drug may be calculated and delivered automatically to a patient at any time during the day or night. Furthermore, when used in

conjunction with metabolic sensors or monitors, pumps may be automatically controlled to provide appropriate doses of a fluidic medium at appropriate times of need, based on sensed or monitored metabolic levels. As a result, pump type delivery devices have become an important aspect of modern medical treatments of various types of medical conditions, such as diabetes, and the like.

(6) While pump type delivery systems have been utilized to solve a number of patient needs, manually operated syringes and injection pens often remain a preferred choice for drug delivery as they now provide integrated safety features and can easily be read to identify the status of drug delivery and the end of dose dispensing. However, manually operated syringes and injection pens are not universally applicable and are not preferred for delivery of all drugs. There remains a need for an adjustable (and/or programmable) infusion system that is precise and reliable and can offer clinicians and patients a small, low cost, light weight, simple to use alternative for parenteral delivery of liquid medicines.

(7) There is a strong market demand for drug delivery devices which are easy-to-use, cost-efficient, and which include integrated safety features. However, manufacturing of such devices can be cost intensive, which results in higher costs to patients. Much of the manufacturing costs can be attributed to the need to maintain a sterile fluid pathway from the drug container to the needle, prior to introduction of the drug to the patient. Some commercial products seek to maintain the sterility of the device by manufacturing the components in a non-sterile environment and then sterilizing the entire device. A recognized downside of such processes is the need to separately fill the drug container after the device sterilization, but prior to drug injection, as most pharmaceutical compounds are not capable of withstanding the device sterilization process. Alternatively, the drug delivery device may be manufactured as a pre-filled device, wherein the device is filled with the drug aseptically during assembly. Such manufacturing processes may be costly since the entire process must be kept sterile and because the fill and assembly lines need to be specially-tailored for the device. Accordingly, this adds substantial operating costs to pharmaceutical companies and contract drug-fillers.

(8) Drug delivery devices are generally prepared by molding or shaping the various components and then assembling the components. The assembling steps and other processing operations typically produce a device that subsequently must be cleaned to remove particulates adhering to the surfaces to satisfy cleanliness standards for drug delivery devices. After cleaning, conventional drug delivery devices are packaged and sterilized. Such delivery devices have been classified into several general types. The first type is assembled and placed in sterile packaging which can be shipped with a vial or ampoule of a drug or other injectable solution. The vial or ampoule is generally made of glass or other clear material that does not interfere with the stability of the drug during prolonged storage. The delivery device is filled with the drug or other solution at the point of use and injected into the patient. These devices have the disadvantage of increasing the time and difficulty of filling the device at the point of use with increased possibility of contamination of the delivery device and/or drug solution. There is a further risk of glass particles from the ampoules contaminating the drug solution when the ampoules are opened.

(9) Several of these disadvantages are overcome by providing prefilled delivery devices which can be filled with a suitable drug solution prior to use. Prefilled delivery devices, as the term is known in the art, are devices that are filled by the drug manufacturer and shipped to the health care provider or self-administering patient in a condition that is ready for use. Prefilled delivery devices have the advantage of convenience and ease of application with reduced risk of contamination of the drug solution. Prefilled drug delivery devices are generally assembled and packaged in clean rooms to maintain proper cleanliness levels. The clean rooms are equipped with extensive filter assemblies and air control systems to remove particulates and pyrogens from the air in the room and to prevent particulates and pyrogens from entering the room. The operators and other personnel in the clean room are required to wear appropriate protective garments to reduce contamination of the air and the drug delivery devices being manufactured or assembled. As people and equipment

enter and leave the clean room, the risk of contamination and introduction of foreign particulates and pyrogens increases. Various operations are able to form clean and sterile drug delivery devices. However, subsequent handling, filling and printing of the drug delivery device can contaminate the device. It is then necessary to clean and sterilize such conventional drug delivery devices before use. Accordingly, there is a continuing need in the industry for an improved system for manufacturing and assembling clean and sterile medical devices and filling such devices.

SUMMARY

(10) The present invention provides devices and methods for establishing aseptic connections between two or more components or subassemblies. The devices may be used in medical devices such as drug delivery pumps. In some embodiments, a connection is made between a drug container and a fluid pathway connection assembly. The fluid pathway connection assembly may include a connection hub, a piercing member, and a piercing member retainer. The mechanism may further include a first film or seal covering an aperture, thereby maintaining the aseptic condition of a cavity adjacent the aperture. The drug container may hold a fluid drug and include a pierceable seal. A second film may cover an aperture of one or more components of the drug container and the seal, and thereby maintain the aseptic condition of the pierceable seal. The piercing member may be caused to pierce the first and second film and the pierceable seal to open a fluid pathway for delivery of the fluid drug to a patient.

(11) In a first embodiment, the present invention provides a fluid pathway connection. The fluid pathway connection assembly includes: a connection hub, a piercing member, a piercing member retainer, and a drug container having a cap, a pierceable seal, and a barrel, wherein the piercing member is at least partially disposed in a sterile cavity defined by the connection hub. The drug container may contain a drug fluid for delivery through the fluid pathway connection assembly to the target. The pierceable seal includes a seal barrier that may be penetrated by the piercing member. The fluid pathway connection assembly may further include a first film which is fixedly attached over an aperture over an aperture of the connection hub and prevents foreign substances such as microbes from entering the sterile cavity formed by the connection hub. The drug container may further include a second film fixedly connected over a cavity formed by the pierceable seal and the second film to prevent foreign substances such as microbes from entering the cavity. The first and second films may be pierced by the piercing member. The fluid pathway connection may be initiated directly by the user, or may be activated by another mechanism of the device (as described herein) after some initial user step.

(12) In another embodiment, the present invention provides a drug delivery pump with integrated sterility maintenance features having a housing and an assembly platform, upon which an activation mechanism, a fluid pathway connection assembly, a power and control system, and a drive mechanism having a drug container may be mounted, said fluid pathway connection assembly including a connection hub, a piercing member, a piercing member retainer, and a drug container having a cap, a pierceable seal, and a barrel, wherein the piercing member is at least partially disposed in a sterile cavity defined by the connection hub. The drug container may contain a drug fluid for delivery through the fluid pathway connection assembly to the target. The pierceable seal includes a seal barrier that may be penetrated by the piercing member. The fluid pathway connection assembly may further include a first film which is fixedly attached over an aperture over an aperture of the connection hub and prevents foreign substances such as microbes from entering the sterile cavity formed by the connection hub. The fluid pathway connection assembly may further include a second film fixedly connected over a cavity formed by the pierceable seal and prevents foreign substances such as microbes from entering the cavity. The first and second films may be pierced by the piercing member.

(13) The devices described herein may further include features which prevent the delivery of an excess volume of medicament or delivery at too rapid of a rate, e.g., to prevent a run-away condition of uncontrolled or undesired delivery of the medicament. By providing such automatic

safety mechanisms, the safety of the patient may be ensured. Some medicaments, such as insulin or other treatments for diabetes, can be dangerous, and potentially even deadly, if they are not delivered according to prescribed parameters. The safety features described below may ensure that delivery of the medicament is terminated if delivery deviates from the specified parameters.

(14) In a further embodiment of the present invention, the fluid pathway connection assembly may include one or more biasing members. In one such embodiment, a biasing member may be included to bias the fluid pathway connection assembly to connect, i.e., to open the fluid pathway between the drug container and the fluid conduit which enables drug flow to the needle insertion mechanism and into the target. In such a configuration, the fluid pathway connection assembly is biased to facilitate the connection upon, for example, movement of a pin or blocking aspect. In at least one embodiment, the biasing member(s) may be internal to the fluid pathway connection assembly and/or external to the fluid pathway connection assembly to facilitate the connection once triggered. Additionally or alternatively, one or more biasing members may be included to disconnect the fluid pathway connection assembly. This may provide a desirable safety feature, to disconnect the fluid pathway upon signaling of an error condition either automatically by the drug delivery pump or upon action by the user. Once the fluid pathway connection assembly is disconnected, flow of drug fluid is restricted or blocked between the drug container and the fluid conduit to limit or prevent fluid flow to the needle insertion mechanism and into the target.

(15) According to an aspect of the disclosure, there is provided a fluid pathway connection assembly for use with a drug container in a drug delivery pump. The drug container includes a barrel, a cap and a pierceable seal. The fluid pathway connection assembly includes an unactuated configuration, an actuated configuration, and a delivery configuration. The fluid pathway connection assembly includes a connection hub including an aperture, a first film, an introducer member, a piercing member, and a piercing member retainer. The first film is sealed along the aperture. The connection hub includes a sterile cavity sealed by the first film. The introducer member is at least partially disposed within the sterile cavity in the unactuated configuration. The piercing member is configured to telescope from the introducer member. The piercing member includes a piercing tip at least partially disposed within the introducer member in the unactuated configuration. The piercing member retainer is connected to the piercing member. The introducer member is configured to move relative to the connection hub from the unactuated configuration to the actuated configuration in which the introducer member pierces the first film. The piercing member is configured to telescope from the introducer member to move from the unactuated configuration to the delivery configuration in which the piercing tip is not disposed within the introducer member. The piercing member is adapted to pierce the pierceable seal in the delivery configuration, the piercing member providing a fluid pathway through the piercing member connection hub in the delivery configuration. In at least one embodiment, there is provided a combination of the fluid pathway connection assembly and the drug container. In at least one embodiment, there is provided a drug delivery pump including a housing, an activation mechanism, the fluid pathway connection assembly, and a drug container.

(16) In at least one embodiment, the fluid pathway connection assembly is configured to move the piercing member from the delivery configuration to a retracted configuration wherein the piercing member is disengaged from the pierceable seal in response to a termination mechanism.

(17) The novel embodiments of the present invention provide fluid pathway connections to drug containers, and drug pumps which utilize such connections which are capable of maintaining the sterility of the fluid pathway before, during, and after operation of the device, and which enable active safety controls for the device. Throughout this specification, unless otherwise indicated, “comprise,” “comprises,” and “comprising,” or related terms such as “includes” or “consists of,” are used inclusively rather than exclusively, so that a stated integer or group of integers may include one or more other non-stated integers or groups of integers. As will be described further below, the embodiments of the present invention may include one or more additional components

which may be considered standard components in the industry of medical devices. The components, and the embodiments containing such components, are within the contemplation of the present invention and are to be understood as falling within the breadth and scope of the present invention.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) The following non-limiting embodiments of the invention are described herein with reference to the following drawings, wherein:

(2) FIG. 1A is an isometric view of an embodiment of a drug delivery pump;

(3) FIG. 1B shows an isometric view of the interior components of the drug delivery pump shown in FIG. 1A;

(4) FIG. 1C shows an isometric view of the bottom of the drug delivery pump shown in FIG. 1A;

(5) FIG. 2A is an isometric view of an embodiment of a fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container in an unmounted configuration;

(6) FIG. 2B is an isometric view of the embodiment shown in FIG. 2A in a mounted, but unactuated, configuration;

(7) FIG. 3A shows an exploded view of a fluid pathway connection assembly according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(8) FIG. 3B shows a cross-sectional view of the exploded fluid pathway connection assembly of FIG. 3A;

(9) FIG. 4A is a cross-sectional side view of an embodiment of a fluid pathway connection assembly and a drug container in a mounted, but unactuated, configuration;

(10) FIG. 4B is an enlarged fragmentary cross-sectional side view of the embodiment shown in FIG. 4A;

(11) FIG. 5A is a cross-sectional side view of the embodiment of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIG. 4A in an actuated configuration;

(12) FIG. 5B is an enlarged fragmentary cross-sectional side view of the embodiment shown in FIG. 5A;

(13) FIG. 6A is a cross-sectional side view of the embodiment of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIGS. 4A and 5A in a delivery configuration;

(14) FIG. 6B is an enlarged fragmentary cross-sectional side view of the embodiment shown in FIG. 6A;

(15) FIG. 7 shows an isometric view of a connection hub according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(16) FIG. 8 shows an isometric view of a plate according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(17) FIG. 9 shows an isometric view of an embodiment of a piercing member retainer according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(18) FIG. 10 shows an isometric view of an embodiment of an introducer member retainer according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(19) FIG. 11A is an isometric view of a second embodiment of a fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container in an unmounted configuration;

(20) FIG. 11B is an isometric view of the embodiment shown in FIG. 11A in a mounted, but unactuated, configuration;

(21) FIG. 12A is a cross-sectional side view of the embodiment of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIGS. 11A-11B in a mounted, but unactuated, configuration;

(22) FIG. 12B is an enlarged fragmentary cross-sectional side view of the embodiment shown in

FIG. 12A;

(23) FIG. 13A is a cross-sectional side view of the embodiment of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIG. 12A in an actuated configuration;

(24) FIG. 13B is an enlarged fragmentary cross-sectional side view of the embodiment shown in FIG. 13A;

(25) FIG. 14A is a cross-sectional side view of the embodiment of the fluid pathway connection assembly and a drug container of FIGS. 12A and 13A in a delivery configuration;

(26) FIG. 14B is an enlarged fragmentary cross-sectional side view of the embodiment shown in FIG. 14A;

(27) FIG. 15A is a further isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly and container of FIGS. 11A-11B in a mounted, but unactuated, configuration;

(28) FIG. 15B is an enlarged fragmentary isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly of FIG. 15A;

(29) FIG. 16A is a further isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly and container of FIGS. 11A-11B in an actuated configuration;

(30) FIG. 16B is an enlarged fragmentary isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly of FIG. 16A;

(31) FIG. 17A is a further isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly and container of FIGS. 11A-11B in a delivery configuration;

(32) FIG. 17B is an enlarged fragmentary isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly of FIG. 17A;

(33) FIG. 18A is a bottom side view of the fluid pathway connection assembly and container of FIG. 17A;

(34) FIG. 18B is an enlarged fragmentary isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIG. 18A;

(35) FIG. 19 shows an isometric view of a connection hub according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(36) FIG. 20 shows an isometric view of an embodiment of an introducer member retainer according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(37) FIG. 21 shows an isometric view of an embodiment of a piercing member retainer according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(38) FIG. 22 shows an isometrically exploded view of a fluid pathway connection assembly according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(39) FIG. 23A shows an isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIG. 22 in an unmounted configuration;

(40) FIG. 23B is an isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIG. 23A in a mounted, but unactuated, configuration;

(41) FIG. 23C is an isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIG. 23B in an actuated configuration;

(42) FIG. 23D is an isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIGS. 23B-23C in a delivery configuration;

(43) FIG. 24A is a cross-sectional side view of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIG. 23B in the mounted, but unactuated, configuration;

(44) FIG. 24B is an enlarged fragmentary cross-sectional side view of the embodiment shown in FIG. 24A;

(45) FIG. 25A is a cross-sectional side view of the embodiment of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIG. 23B in an actuated configuration;

(46) FIG. 25B is an enlarged fragmentary cross-sectional side view of the embodiment shown in FIG. 25A;

(47) FIG. 26A is a cross-sectional side view of the embodiment of the fluid pathway connection

assembly and drug container of FIGS. 24A and 25A in a delivery configuration;

(48) FIG. 26B is an enlarged fragmentary cross-sectional side view of the embodiment shown in FIG. 26A;

(49) FIG. 27 shows an isometric view of a connection hub according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(50) FIG. 28 shows a side elevational view of an embodiment of an introducer member retainer according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(51) FIG. 29 shows an isometric view of an embodiment of a piercing member retainer according to at least one embodiment of the present invention;

(52) FIG. 30 shows a fragmentary isometric view of the interior components of a drug delivery pump incorporating the fluid pathway connection assembly of FIGS. 22-26B;

(53) FIG. 31A is a fragmentary isometric view of a fluid pathway connection assembly and a drug container of at least one embodiment of the present invention during fluid connection;

(54) FIG. 31B is a fragmentary isometric view of the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container of FIG. 31A upon disconnection.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(55) As used herein to describe the drive mechanisms, drug delivery pumps, or any of the relative positions of the components of the present invention, the terms “axial” or “axially” refer generally to a longitudinal axis “A” around which the drive mechanisms are preferably positioned, although not necessarily symmetrically there-around. The term “radial” refers generally to a direction normal to axis A. The terms “proximal,” “rear,” “rearward,” “back,” or “backward” refer generally to an axial direction in the direction “P”. The terms “distal,” “front,” “frontward,” “depressed,” or “forward” refer generally to an axial direction in the direction “D”. As used herein, the term “glass” should be understood to include other similarly non-reactive materials suitable for use in a pharmaceutical grade application that would normally require glass, including but not limited to certain non-reactive polymers such as cyclic olefin copolymers (COC) and cyclic olefin polymers (COP). The term “plastic” may include both thermoplastic and thermosetting polymers.

Thermoplastic polymers can be re-softened to their original condition by heat; thermosetting polymers cannot. As used herein, the term “plastic” refers primarily to moldable thermoplastic polymers such as, for example, polyethylene and polypropylene, or an acrylic resin, that also typically contain other ingredients such as curatives, fillers, reinforcing agents, colorants, and/or plasticizers, etc., and that can be formed or molded under heat and pressure. As used herein, the term “plastic” is not meant to include glass, non-reactive polymers, or elastomers that are approved for use in applications where they are in direct contact with therapeutic liquids that can interact with plastic or that can be degraded by substituents that could otherwise enter the liquid from plastic. The term “elastomer,” “elastomeric” or “elastomeric material” refers primarily to cross-linked thermosetting rubbery polymers that are more easily deformable than plastics but that are approved for use with pharmaceutical grade fluids and are not readily susceptible to leaching or gas migration under ambient temperature and pressure. “Fluid” refers primarily to liquids, but can also include suspensions of solids dispersed in liquids, and gasses dissolved in or otherwise present together within liquids inside the fluid-containing portions of the pumps. According to various aspects and embodiments described herein, reference is made to a “biasing member”, which may be any member that is capable of storing and releasing energy. Non-limiting examples include a spring, such as for example a coiled spring, a compression or extension spring, a torsional spring, and a leaf spring, a resiliently compressible or elastic band, or any other member with similar functions. In at least one embodiment of the present invention, the biasing member is a spring.

(56) The novel devices of the present invention provide container connections which maintain the sterility and/or aseptic condition of the fluid pathway, and drug delivery pumps which incorporate such sterile fluid pathway connection assemblies to drug containers. Such devices are safe and easy to use, and are aesthetically and ergonomically appealing for self-administering patients. The fluid

pathway connection may be initiated directly by the user, or may be activated by another mechanism of the device (as described herein) after some initial user step. The devices described herein incorporate features which make activation, operation, and lock-out of the device simple for even untrained users. The novel devices of the present invention provide these desirable features without problems associated with known prior art devices. Certain non-limiting embodiments of the novel drug delivery pumps, fluid pathway connection assemblies, and their respective components are described further herein with reference to the accompanying figures.

(57) Conventional drug delivery devices often require filling at time-of-use because the terminal sterilization of the device cannot be completed with the pharmaceutical drug within the drug container. Various pharmaceutical drugs cannot withstand the temperatures, pressures, and other conditions necessary for sterilization of the device after assembly. In other words, because existing manufacturing processes require sterilization of the entire device, the drug cannot be “pre-filled” into the device prior to sterilization. This adds a complex step after final assembly of the device, which often requires costly additional equipment, handling of separate drug containers, and/or training of the patient to perform the filling step themselves prior to injection. Instead, the embodiments of the present invention enable the manufacture, assembly, and use of pre-filled drug delivery devices which maintain the sterility and/or aseptic condition of the fluid pathway assembly through the various manufacturing steps.

(58) Additionally, because the drug delivery devices which incorporate the novel embodiments of the present invention do not need to be terminally sterilized, the components of the devices may be constructed of other, often less expensive, materials which would not normally withstand the sterilization environment. For example, less expensive plastics may be utilized for certain device components because they do not need to be sterilized after assembly. Furthermore, the embodiments of the present invention permit device architecture and/or component integration in ways which are not suitable for devices that require terminal sterilization. For example, when sterilization of the entire device is necessary, the device architecture often requires adequate spacing of components to permit the sterilization gas or material to effectively reach the target surfaces. Removing the need for terminal sterilization permits reduction or elimination of those spaces and allows for device architectures that offer smaller overall dimensions, human factors benefits, and/or industrial design options that are not available for devices that require terminal sterilization.

(59) In other words, the embodiments of the present invention may allow the manufacturer to sterilize only the components which will be in contact with the drug fluid and/or which are necessary to maintain sterile and/or aseptic fluid pathways. These embodiments may also allow the pharmaceutical filler to maintain the sterility and/or aseptic condition of these components during the filling and finishing steps associated with the assembly of the drug delivery devices. Similarly, drug delivery devices which incorporate the fluid pathway connection assemblies of the present invention may have smaller or more efficient geometries as the device does not have to be configured for sterilization after assembly.

(60) Additionally, the embodiments of the present invention allow for the utilization of standard fill-finish processes to fill the drug container. This greatly simplifies the manufacturing processes used to build drug delivery devices. Standard fill-finish processes utilize trays which hold multiple drug containers, such as syringes. The embodiments of the present invention enable a drug delivery device manufacturer, pharmaceutical company, or contract drug filler to fill the drug containers for infusion or injection pumps using the same standard fill-finish processes. These drug containers can be filled aseptically, as is common industry practice, in a cost-efficient manner. After mounting of the fluid pathway connection assembly the combined assembly can then be mated into a drug delivery device without requiring the remainder of the device components to be sterilized.

Accordingly, embodiments of the present invention may provide novel components which enable the fluid pathway assemblies to be sterilized, assembled, filled, and incorporated into drug delivery

devices in a cost-efficient and streamlined process.

(61) In the processes of filling drug containers and other drug delivery devices, it is sometimes necessary to connect two or more sterile components or subassemblies. For example, wearable injectors or drug pumps may include a drug container which may be filled with a fluid drug using standard pharmaceutical fill-finish processes. After filling of the drug container, it may be necessary to connect the drug container to one or more additional components or subassemblies such that a fluid communication may be established between the drug container and these components. Maintaining the fluid path in an aseptic condition is critical, preventing the introduction of harmful microbes or particulates to the drug and/or fluid pathway. The connection of two or more aseptic components or subassemblies is typically performed in an aseptic environment, such as a clean room, thereby ensuring that no harmful microbes or particulates are introduced to the assembly. This, however, may lead to increased cost to manufacture the drug delivery devices.

(62) The novel devices of the present invention provide fluid pathway connection assemblies with integrated safety features and drug delivery pumps which incorporate such fluid pathway connection assemblies. Such devices are safe and easy to use, and are aesthetically and ergonomically appealing for self-administering patients. The devices described herein incorporate features which make activation, operation, and lock-out of the device simple for even untrained users. The novel devices of the present invention provide these desirable features without any of the problems associated with known prior art devices. Certain non-limiting embodiments of the novel drug delivery pump, fluid pathway connection assemblies, and their respective components are described further herein with reference to the accompanying figures. The devices described herein may be configured for delivery of controlled substances and may further include features that prevent so-called “run-away” delivery of medicament. When delivering controlled substances, this may be an important safety feature to protect the patient. For example, some medicaments, such as insulin, can be dangerous, and potentially even deadly, when administered in too large a quantity and/or at too rapid of a rate. By providing such automatic safety stop mechanisms, the safety of the patient may be ensured.

(63) As used herein, the term “pump” is intended to include any number of drug delivery systems which are capable of dispensing a fluid to a target upon activation. Such drug delivery systems include, for example, injection systems, infusion pumps, bolus injectors, and the like. FIGS. 1A-1C show an exemplary drug delivery device according to at least one embodiment of the present invention. The drug delivery device may be utilized to administer delivery of a drug treatment into a target. As shown in FIGS. 1A-1C, the drug pump **10** includes a pump housing **12**. Pump housing **12** may include one or more housing subcomponents which are fixedly engageable to facilitate easier manufacturing, assembly, and operation of the drug pump. For example, drug pump **10** includes a pump housing **12** which includes an upper housing **12A** and a lower housing **12B**. The drug pump may further include an activation mechanism **14**, a status indicator (not shown), and a window **18**. Window **18** may be any translucent or transmissive surface through which the operation of the drug pump may be viewed. As shown in FIG. 1B, drug pump **10** further includes assembly platform **20**, drive mechanism **100** having drug container **50**, insertion mechanism **200**, fluid pathway connection assembly **300**, and power and control system **400**. A sterile fluid conduit **30** (as in FIG. 30) may fluidly connect the fluid pathway connection assembly **300** with the insertion mechanism **200**. One or more of the components of such drug pumps may be modular in that they may be, for example, pre-assembled as separate components and configured into position onto the assembly platform **20** of the drug pump **10** during manufacturing.

(64) The pump housing **12** contains all of the device components and provides a means of removably attaching the device **10** to a target, such as tissue of a user. The pump housing **12** also provides protection to the interior components of the device **10** against environmental influences. The pump housing **12** is ergonomically and aesthetically designed in size, shape, and related

features to facilitate easy packaging, storage, handling, and use by users who may be untrained and/or physically impaired. Furthermore, the external surface of the pump housing **12** may be utilized to provide product labeling, safety instructions, and the like. Additionally, as described above, housing **12** may include certain components, such as a status indicator (not shown) and window **18**, which may provide operation feedback to the user.

(65) In at least one embodiment, the drug pump **10** provides an activation mechanism **14** that is displaced by the user to trigger the start command to the power and control system **400**. In a preferred embodiment, the activation mechanism is a start button **14** that is located through the pump housing **12**, such as through an aperture in the upper housing **12A** (as in FIG. **1A**), or between upper housing **12A** and lower housing **12B** (not shown), and which contacts a control arm (not shown) of the power and control system **400**. In at least one embodiment, the start button **14** may be a push button, and in other embodiments, may be an on/off switch, a toggle, or any similar activation feature known in the art. The pump housing **12** may also include a status indicator (not shown) and a window **18**. In other embodiments, one or more of the activation mechanism **14**, the status indicator, the window **18**, and combinations thereof may be provided on the upper housing **12A** or the lower housing **12B** such as, for example, on a side visible to the user when the drug pump **10** is placed on the target. Housing **12** is described in further detail hereinafter with reference to other components and embodiments of the present invention.

(66) Drug pump **10** is configured such that, upon activation by a user by depression of the activation mechanism, the drug pump is initiated to: insert a fluid pathway into the target; enable, connect, or open necessary connections between a drug container, a fluid pathway, and a sterile fluid conduit; and force drug fluid stored in the drug container through the fluid pathway and sterile fluid conduit for delivery into a target. Each of these operations may begin simultaneously upon depression of the activation mechanism or, alternatively, one or more operations may be delayed. The fluid pathway connection may be initiated directly by the user, or may be activated by another mechanism of the device (as described herein) after some initial user step.

(67) One or more optional safety mechanisms may be utilized, for example, to prevent premature activation of the drug pump. For example, an optional on-body sensor **24** may be provided in one embodiment as a safety feature to ensure that the power and control system **400**, or the activation mechanism **14**, cannot be engaged unless the drug pump **10** is in contact with the target. In one such embodiment, the on-body sensor is located on the bottom of lower housing **12B** where it may come in contact with the target. Upon displacement of the on-body sensor, depression of the activation mechanism is permitted. Accordingly, in at least one embodiment the on-body sensor **24** is a mechanical safety mechanism, such as for example a mechanical lock out, that prevents triggering of the drug pump **10** by the activation mechanism **14**. In another embodiment, the on-body sensor may be an electro-mechanical sensor such as a mechanical lock out that sends a signal to the power and control system **400** to permit activation. In still other embodiments, the on-body sensor can be electrically based such as, for example, a capacitive- or impedance-based sensor which must detect tissue before permitting activation of the power and control system **400**.

(68) In at least one embodiment, housing **12** is configured to at least partially prevent harmful matter from entering the drug pump. For example, the housing may be configured to restrict the passage of fluids into the drug pump. This may allow the device to be worn in the shower, while swimming, or during other activities. Use of an electrically based skin sensor may eliminate potential points of entry into the drug pump. These concepts are not mutually exclusive and one or more combinations may be utilized within the breadth of the present invention to prevent, for example, premature activation of the drug pump. In a preferred embodiment, the drug pump **10** utilizes one or more mechanical on-body sensors. Additional integrated safety mechanisms are described herein with reference to other components of the novel drug pumps.

(69) Power and Control System:

(70) The power and control system **400** includes a power source, which provides the energy for

various electrical components within the drug pump, one or more feedback mechanisms, a microcontroller, a circuit board, one or more conductive pads, and one or more interconnects. Other components commonly used in such electrical systems may also be included, as would be appreciated by one having ordinary skill in the art. The one or more feedback mechanisms may include, for example, audible alarms such as piezo alarms and/or light indicators such as light emitting diodes (LEDs). The microcontroller may be, for example, a microprocessor. The power and control system **400** controls several device interactions with the user and interfaces with the drive mechanism **100**. In one embodiment, the power and control system **400** interfaces with the control arm to identify when the on-body sensor **24** and/or the activation mechanism **14** have been activated. The power and control system **400** may also interface with the status indicator **16** of the pump housing **12**, which may be a transmissive or translucent material which permits light transfer, to provide visual feedback to the user. The power and control system **400** interfaces with the drive mechanism **100** through one or more interconnects to relay status indication, such as activation, drug delivery, and end-of-dose, to the user. Such status indication may be presented to the user via auditory tones, such as through the audible alarms, and/or via visual indicators, such as through the LEDs. In a preferred embodiment, the control interfaces between the power and control system and the other components of the drug pump are not engaged or connected until activation by the user. This is a desirable safety feature that prevents accidental operation of the drug pump and may additionally maintain the energy contained in the power source during storage, transportation, and the like.

(71) The power and control system **400** may be configured to provide a number of different status indicators to the user. For example, the power and control system **400** may be configured such that after the on-body sensor and/or trigger mechanism have been pressed, the power and control system **400** provides a ready-to-start status signal via the status indicator **16** if device start-up checks provide no errors. After providing the ready-to-start status signal and, in an embodiment with the optional on-body sensor, if the on-body sensor remains in contact with the target, the power and control system **400** will power the drive mechanism **100** to begin delivery of the drug treatment through the fluid pathway connection assembly **300** and sterile fluid conduit. In a preferred embodiment of the present invention, the insertion mechanism **200** and the fluid pathway connection assembly **300** may be caused to activate directly or indirectly by user operation of the activation mechanism **14**. During the drug delivery process, the power and control system **400** is configured to provide a dispensing status signal via the status indicator **16**. After the drug has been administered into the target and after the end of any additional dwell time, to ensure that substantially the entire dose has been delivered to the target, the power and control system **400** may provide an okay-to-remove status signal via the status indicator **16**. This may be independently verified by the user by viewing the drive mechanism and drug dose delivery through the window **18** of the pump housing **12**. Additionally, the power and control system **400** may be configured to provide one or more alert signals via the status indicator **16**, such as for example alerts indicative of fault or operation failure situations.

(72) Other power and control system configurations may be utilized with the novel drug pumps of the present invention. For example, certain activation delays may be utilized during drug delivery. As mentioned above, one such delay optionally included within the system configuration is a dwell time which ensures that substantially the entire drug dose has been delivered before signaling completion to the user. Similarly, activation of the device may require a delayed depression (i.e., pushing) of the activation mechanism **14** of the drug pump **10** prior to drug pump activation. Additionally, the system may include a feature which permits the user to respond to the end-of-dose signals and to deactivate or power-down the drug pump. Such a feature may similarly require a delayed depression of the activation mechanism, to prevent accidental deactivation of the device. Such features provide desirable safety integration and ease-of-use parameters to the drug pumps. An additional safety feature may be integrated into the activation mechanism to prevent partial

depression and, therefore, partial activation of the drug pumps. For example, the activation mechanism and/or power and control system may be configured such that the device is either completely off or completely on, to prevent partial activation. Such features are described in further detail hereinafter with regard to other aspects of the novel drug pumps.

(73) Insertion Mechanism:

(74) A number of insertion mechanisms may be utilized within the drug pumps of the present invention. In at least one embodiment, the insertion mechanism **200** includes an insertion mechanism housing having one or more lockout windows, and a base for connection to the assembly platform and/or pump housing (as shown in FIG. **1B** and FIG. **1C**). The connection of the base to the assembly platform **20** may be, for example, such that the bottom of the base is permitted to pass-through a hole in the assembly platform to permit direct contact of the base to the target, as shown in FIG. **1C**. In such configurations, the bottom of the base may include a sealing membrane that is removable prior to use of the drug pump **10**. The insertion mechanism may further include one or more insertion biasing members, a needle, a retraction biasing member, a cannula, and a manifold. The manifold may connect to sterile fluid conduit to permit fluid flow through the manifold, cannula, and into the target during drug delivery.

(75) As used herein, “needle” is intended to refer to a variety of needles including but not limited to conventional hollow needles, such as a rigid hollow steel needles, and solid core needles more commonly referred to as a “trocars.” In some embodiments, the needle is a 27 gauge solid core trocar and in other embodiments, the needle may be any size needle suitable to insert the cannula for the type of drug and drug administration (e.g., subcutaneous, intramuscular, intradermal, etc.) intended. In one embodiment, the insertion mechanism may generally be as described in International Patent Application No. PCT/US2012/53174 published as WO 2013/033421 A2, International Patent Application No. PCT/US2012/053241 published as WO 2013/033467 A2 or International Patent Application No. PCT/US2015/052815, which are included by reference herein in their entirety for all purposes.

(76) Drive Mechanism:

(77) A number of drive mechanisms may be utilized to force fluid from a drug container **50** for delivery into the target. In one such embodiment, the drive mechanism **100** includes a drive housing, a status switch interconnect, and a drug container **50** having a crimp cap **324**, a pierceable seal **326**, a barrel **58**, and a plunger seal **60** within the barrel. The drug container may contain a drug fluid, within the barrel between the pierceable seal and the plunger seal, for delivery through the insertion mechanism and drug pump into the target. The seals described herein may be comprised of a number of materials but are, in a preferred embodiment, comprised of one or more elastomers or rubbers. The drive mechanism may further include a connection mount to guide the insertion of the piercing member of the fluid pathway connection assembly into the barrel **58** of the drug container. The drive mechanism **100** may further contain one or more drive biasing members, one or more release mechanisms, and one or more guides. The components of the drive mechanism function to force a fluid from the drug container out through the pierceable seal, or preferably through the piercing member of the fluid pathway connection assembly, for delivery through the fluid pathway connection assembly, sterile fluid conduit, and insertion mechanism into the target.

(78) In one particular embodiment, the drive mechanism **100** employs one or more compression springs as the biasing member(s). Upon activation of the drug pump by the user, the power and control system **400** may be actuated to directly or indirectly release the compression spring(s) from an energized state. Upon release, the compression spring(s) may bear against and act upon the plunger seal to force the fluid drug out of the drug container. The fluid pathway connection assembly **300** may be connected through the pierceable seal prior to, concurrently with, or after activation of the drive mechanism to permit fluid flow from the drug container, through the fluid pathway connection assembly, sterile fluid conduit, and insertion mechanism, and into the target for drug delivery. In at least one embodiment, the fluid flows through only a manifold or a needle, and

a cannula, of the insertion mechanism, thereby maintaining the sterility of the fluid pathway before and during drug delivery. Such components and their functions are described in further detail hereinafter.

(79) The components of the drive mechanism **100**, upon activation, may be used to drive axial translation in the distal direction of the plunger seal of the drug container. Optionally, the drive mechanism **100** may include one or more compliance features which enable additional axial translation of the plunger seal to, for example, ensure that substantially the entire drug dose has been delivered to the target and make sure that the feedback contact mechanisms have connected. Additionally or alternatively, the plunger seal, itself, may have some compressibility permitting a compliance push of drug fluid from the drug container. The drive mechanism **100** may similarly include one or more status indication mechanisms, such as interconnects and contacts, to measure and communicate the status of the drive mechanism before, during, and after operation of the drive mechanism and the device to the user. Furthermore, the drive mechanism **100** may include one or more safety mechanisms, such as premature activation prevention mechanisms, to enhance the safety and usability of the mechanism and the device. Further details related to the drive mechanism **100** are provided herein with reference to other components of the drug pump. In one embodiment, the insertion mechanism may generally be as described in International Patent Application No. PCT/US2012/05174 published as WO 2013/033421 A2 or International Patent Application No. PCT/US2013/057259 published as WO 2014-036239 A2, which are included by reference herein in their entirety for all purposes.

(80) Fluid Pathway Connection Assembly:

(81) Embodiments of the present fluid pathway connection assemblies allow connections to be made between two or more components or subassemblies in a septic environment while maintaining the aseptic condition of the fluid flow path. As will be seen, the fluid pathway connection assemblies may be arranged in any orientation. For example, as illustrated in FIGS. **2A-10**, the piercing member may be axially aligned with the drug container. In other embodiments, as shown in FIGS. **22-29**, the fluid pathway connection assembly may be arranged such that the piercing member of the fluid pathway connection assembly is oriented at an angle with respect to the drug container. In an alternative embodiment, the piercing member may be arranged in an arcuate manner. An exemplary embodiment of such an arrangement is shown in FIGS. **11A-21**. The orientation of the fluid pathway connection assembly may be chosen based on the desired overall size and shape of drug pump **10** and the available space within the drug pump.

(82) FIGS. **2A-10** show one embodiment of such a fluid pathway connection assembly. As seen in FIGS. **2A-2B**, the fluid pathway connection assembly **300** may be connected to the drug container **50**. FIG. **2A** shows these components prior to connection and FIG. **2B** shows the components after connection. As will be described herein, fluid pathway connection assembly **300** may be mounted to drug container **50** without compromising the aseptic condition of the fluid flow path. Fluid pathway connection assembly **300** includes introducer member **320**, piercing member **316**, introducer member retainer **330**, piercing member retainer **314**, connection hub **312**, plate **334**, biasing member **336**, sterile boot **340**, and first film **318**. FIGS. **3A-3B** show exploded views of the fluid pathway connection assembly **300**.

(83) According to one aspect of the invention (see FIGS. **4A** and **4B**), the connection hub **312** includes a cavity **312A**. Sterile boot **340** may further define the cavity **312A** as aseptic. In one embodiment, sterile boot **340** is fixedly connected at a first end to connection hub **312** and at a second end to introducer member retainer **330**. Sterile boot **340** may be constructed from a flexible material, such as an elastomer, thereby allowing the sterile boot to deform to maintain engagement with both connection hub **312** and introducer member retainer **330** during operation. A first film **318** is disposed covering an aperture **312B** of connection hub **312** to prevent microbes and other contaminants from entering cavity **312A** through aperture **312B**. In this way, the area contained or bounded by the sterile boot **340**, the connection hub **312**, and the first film **318** defines cavity **312A**.

and maintains the aseptic condition of the cavity **312A**.

(84) In an unmounted configuration, such as illustrated in FIG. 2B, and in an initial, unactuated configuration, as shown in FIGS. 4A-4B, at least a portion of introducer member **320** is disposed within aseptic cavity **312A**. At least a piercing tip of the piercing member **316** is partially retained within lumen **320A** of introducer member **320**, the piercing member **316** being disposed to telescope within the introducer member **320**. The piercing member **316** is also at least partially disposed in piercing member retainer **314**. In this way, introducer member **320** and piercing member **316** are likewise maintained in an aseptic condition within cavity **312A**.

(85) Piercing member **316** is engaged with piercing member retainer **314** such that translation of piercing member retainer **314** is transferred to piercing member **316** such that they maintain a substantially fixed spatial relationship throughout operation. Piercing member **316** may be engaged with piercing member retainer **314** using any method known to one skilled in the art, such as bonding, press-fit, staking, etc. The piercing member **316** may be, for example, a hollow needle.

(86) Introducer member **320** is at least partially retained by introducer member retainer **330** and is engaged with the introducer member retainer **330** such that translation of introducer member retainer **330** is transferred to introducer member **320** such that they maintain a substantially fixed spatial relationship throughout operation. Introducer member **320** may be engaged with introducer member retainer **330** using any method known to one skilled in the art, such as bonding, press-fit, staking, or any other appropriate method.

(87) Piercing member retainer **314** and introducer member retainer **330** are engaged with connection hub **312** and may be configured for translation with respect to the connection hub in a direction parallel to the long axis of piercing member **316** (axis “A” shown in FIG. 4B). Connection hub **312**, piercing member retainer **314**, and introducer member retainer **330** may include one or more features to maintain orientation and position with respect to one another as will be described in more detail below.

(88) The fluid pathway connection assembly **300** may further be provided with an insertion driver disposed to advance one or both of the piercing member **316** and the introducer member **320** toward the drug container **50**. In this embodiment, at least one biasing member **336** is provided to advance one or both of the piercing member **316** and the introducer member **320** toward the drug container **50**. Biasing member **336** is initially in a compressed or energized condition and is restrained from decompressing or de-energizing. A first end of biasing member **336** is in contact with plate **334**, which is axially stationary, and a second end of biasing member **336** is in contact with piercing member retainer **314**. In one embodiment, biasing member **336** is in contact with shoulder **314D** of piercing member retainer **314**. Motion of plate **334** is restrained by engagement with snaps **312C** of connection hub **312** (see FIG. 7) which are inserted through passages **334A** of plate **334** (see FIG. 8) during assembly. In an initial configuration, shaft **314A** of piercing member retainer **314** (see FIG. 9) passes through central bore **334B** of plate **334** and is engaged by interlock **338** (see FIGS. 2A, 2B, 4A, 4B). Interlock **338** is located on the distal side of plate **334** and engages one or more lobes **314B** on shaft **314A** to prevent translation of piercing member retainer **314** with respect to plate **334**. In this way, decompression or de-energizing of biasing member **336** is restrained. As will be described further herein, transformation of interlock **338**, to a configuration in which it does not restrain translation of piercing member retainer **314**, allows decompression of biasing member **336** and connection of the fluid pathway to drug container **50**.

(89) The drug container **50** may include a crimp cap **324** that maintains a connection between a pierceable seal **326** and a barrel **58**. The pierceable seal maintains the fluid drug within the barrel and prevents microbes and other substances from entering the drug chamber. A recess **328** (best seen in FIG. 4B) is formed by the geometry of the pierceable seal **326**. A second film **322** is affixed to the drug container such that it encloses recess **328**, thereby maintaining recess **328** in an aseptic condition.

(90) The first and second films may be constructed of any material capable of providing the barrier

properties required to maintain the aseptic condition of the associated surfaces. In a preferred embodiment, the films are constructed from a foil material. Alternatively, the films may be any type of sterilizable membrane, film, or foil. Additionally, the film may be removable and/or pierceable as well as breathable and/or permeable.

(91) A surface treatment may be applied to the exterior surfaces of both first film **318** and second film **322** prior to joining the fluid pathway connection assembly and the drug container. The surface treatment may contain antimicrobial, antibacterial, or antiviral compounds to limit or reduce the number of such substances on the surface of the seals.

(92) Connection hub **312** may include a barrel-engaging aspect **312D**. Barrel-engaging aspect **312D** may include one or more flex arms **312E** configured to engage crimp cap **324** and/or neck **58A** of barrel **58**. During connection, flex arms **312E** may engage crimp cap **324** or another portion of the drug container, thereby limiting axial translation of the fluid pathway connection assembly with respect to the drug container. In this position, first film **318** and second film **322** are in contact with, or in close proximity to, one another. In one embodiment, first film **318** and second film **322** include an adhesive such that the films are bonded to one another during assembly.

(93) FIGS. **4A-4B** show a cross-sectional side view of the connection hub **312** and drug container **50** in a mounted, unactuated configuration, that is, after they have been joined. In this configuration, introducer member **320** is at least partially disposed within cavity **312A** and engagement of interlock **338** with piercing member retainer **314** retains biasing member **336** in a compressed or energized state. First film **318** and second film **322** are intact, thereby maintaining the aseptic condition of cavity **312A** and pierceable seal **326**, respectively.

(94) An actuated configuration is illustrated in FIGS. **5A-5B**. In one embodiment, activation may displace or transform interlock **338** such that it no longer restricts translation of piercing member retainer **314**. Upon activation, the piercing member retainer **314** and introducer member retainer **330** may be translated axially with respect to the connection hub and drug container **50**. The translation may be caused by decompression or de-energizing of biasing member **336**. In one embodiment, biasing member **336** is a compression spring. Because piercing member retainer **314** is in contact with introducer member retainer **330**, as piercing member retainer **314** translates, introducer member retainer **330** translates together with piercing member retainer **314**. For example, proximal face **314C** of piercing member retainer **314** (see FIG. **9**) may contact projections **330A** of introducer member retainer **330** (see FIG. **10**). Proximal face **314C** may include a chamfered or radiused portion which contacts projections **330A**. The contacting faces of piercing member retainer **314** and introducer member retainer **330** may be configured such that piercing member retainer **314** applies a radially inwardly directed force to projections **330A** and, thereby, extensions **330D**, in addition to an axial force. However, initially, fingers **330C** of extensions **330D** are prevented from inward displacement by contact with ribs **312G** of connection hub **312** (see FIGS. **3A**, **3B**, **5B**). Hence, introducer member retainer **330** translates along with piercing member retainer **314**. Translation of the piercing member retainer **314** causes piercing member **316** to translate and translation of the introducer member retainer **330** causes translation of the introducer member **320**. This translation causes the introducer member **320** to pierce first film **318** and second film **322**, as shown in FIGS. **5A-5B**. It will be appreciated that, because the piercing member **316** is disposed within introducer member **320**, it does not contact the first **318** and second **322** films; hence, any contaminants present on the surface of the films do not come in contact with the piercing member **316**.

(95) After the introducer member **320** pierces first film **318** and second film **322**, translation of introducer member retainer **330** is restricted such that its translation is terminated with the tip of the introducer member disposed in recess **328** (i.e., the introducer member does not pass through pierceable seal **326**). Translation of introducer member retainer **330** may, for example, be restricted by contact of a portion of the proximal face **330B** with flange **312F** of connection hub **312**. It is not necessary that the entire proximal face **330B** of introducer member retainer **330** contact flange

312F. For example, fingers **330C** may contact flange **312F**. In this position, fingers **330C** are no longer in contact with ribs **312G** of connection hub **312**. Because of this, extensions **330D** are able to flex radially inward. As a result, continued decompression of biasing member **336** and translation of piercing member retainer **314** causes the extensions **330D** to move inward and piercing member retainer **314** is able to pass over introducer member retainer **330**.

(96) Turning now to FIGS. **6A-6B**, there is illustrated a delivery configuration of the fluid pathway connection assembly **300**. Continued decompression of biasing member **336** may cause the piercing member retainer **314** to be further displaced, leading to the piercing of pierceable seal **326** by piercing member **316**. Hence, with further translation of introducer member retainer **330** prevented by contact with connection hub **312**, continued decompression of biasing member **336** causes piercing member retainer **314** to translate in a proximal direction relative to introducer member retainer **330**. After piercing of the pierceable seal, a fluid path is established from the drug container and through the piercing member **316**. Those of skill in the art will appreciate that the piercing member **316** may also be in fluid communication with a conduit **30** (as in FIG. **30**), the conduit being configured to carry the fluid contents to a delivery mechanism, such as an insertion mechanism, for delivery to a patient.

(97) In an alternative embodiment, piercing of the first and second films occurs at the time of assembly. In such an embodiment, piercing of the pierceable seal at or near the time-of-use may be initiated by interaction with an activation mechanism.

(98) In at least one embodiment, the first and second films are pierced by the introducer member at a first time, for example time of assembly, and the piercing member pierces the pierceable seal at a later time, for example upon activation. In such an embodiment, the end of the piercing member may remain disposed within recess **328** until time-of-use. The pierceable seal may be configured such that, in response to hydraulic and/or pneumatic pressure within the drug chamber, pierceable seal **326** deforms or is displaced and is caused to come into contact with the piercing member. This deformation of the pierceable seal **326** leads to the piercing of the seal by the piercing member **316**. In such an embodiment, introducer member **320** may be retracted after piercing the first and second films.

(99) Although the embodiment shown in FIGS. **2A-10** is configured such that piercing member **316** is substantially axially aligned with drug container **50**, one skilled in the art would recognize that this orientation can be configured in any orientation. For example, the axis of piercing member **316** may be oriented orthogonal to the central axis of the drug container **50**. Alternatively, the axes may be oriented at any angle between parallel and orthogonal. Selection of this angle or orientation may be chosen based on the space requirements of drug pump **10**.

(100) In another embodiment, shown in FIGS. **11A-21**, the introducer member and piercing member are arranged in an arcuate manner. The arcuate configuration of the fluid pathway connection assembly may allow the footprint of the fluid pathway connection assembly to be reduced, allowing for a smaller overall size of drug pump **10**. Fluid pathway connection assembly **1300** includes introducer member **1320**, piercing member **1316**, introducer member retainer **1330**, piercing member retainer **1314**, connection hub **1312**, shaft **1342**, and first film **1318**. As described above, connection hub **1312** may be configured to engage drug container **1050**, for example, by engaging crimp cap **1324** and/or neck **1058A** of drug container **1050**.

(101) Introducer member **1320** may be either directly or indirectly coupled to introducer member retainer **1330**. For example, in the embodiment shown, introducer member **1320** is fixedly connected to first sleeve **1344**. In turn, first sleeve **1344** is engaged with second sleeve **1346**. Finally, second sleeve **1346** is engaged with introducer member retainer **1330**, for example by the keyed engagement shown. First sleeve **1344** and second sleeve **1346** may further retain septum **1348**, through which piercing member **1316** may pass.

(102) Similarly, piercing member **1316** may be directly or indirectly coupled to piercing member retainer **1314**. In the embodiment shown, piercing member **1316** is engaged with keeper **1350**.

Keeper **1350** is engaged with piercing member retainer **1314** by, for example, the keyed arrangement shown.

(103) In an initial, unactuated configuration, shown in FIGS. **12A-12B**, introducer member **1320** is initially at least partially disposed in cavity **1312A**. Piercing member **1316** is at least partially disposed within the lumen **1320A** of introducer member **1320**. Cavity **1312A** is maintained in an aseptic condition by first film **1318**. The aseptic condition of cavity **1312A** may be further maintained by cap **1354** and ring seal **1352**. Ring seal **1352** is held in sealing engagement with connection hub **1312** and/or introducer member **1320** by cap **1354**. Although ring seal **1352** is shown here with a circular cross-section, the ring seal may take on any shape known to one skilled in the art. Alternatively, for example, the aseptic condition may be maintained by a septum.

(104) Upon activation, introducer member retainer **1330** and piercing member retainer **1314** are caused to rotate about shaft **1342**. It will be appreciated that shaft **1342** may be integrally formed with connection hub **1312**, as shown in FIG. **19**, may be a feature of housing **12**, or may be a pin or other component engaged with connection hub **1312** or housing **12**. While the latter two of these embodiments are not specifically illustrated, they will be readily understood by those of skill in the art. An insertion driver may be provided to advance one or both of the piercing member **1316** and the introducer member **1320** toward the drug container **1050**. For example, the rotation about the axis of the shaft may be caused by de-energizing of a biasing member, such as a torsion spring. Alternatively, the rotation may be caused by a driving member of drug pump **10**. For example, needle insertion mechanism **200** may include a driving member that, upon activation, contacts an aspect of piercing member retainer **1314** and causes rotation of piercing member retainer **1314** and introducer member retainer **1330**. In another embodiment, the biasing member of the needle insertion mechanism bears against the piercing member retainer **1314** and causes rotation thereof.

(105) Piercing member retainer **1314** and introducer member retainer **1330** may initially rotate as a unit. Referring to FIGS. **15B** and **21**, introducer member retainer **1330** may initially be disposed between projection **1314E** and tooth **1314F**, both features of piercing member retainer **1314**. The retainers move in conjunction to the actuated configuration shown in FIGS. **13A-13B**. In this position, the introducer member **1320** has pierced the first film **1318** and second film **1322**, but has not pierced pierceable seal **1326**. At or near to this position, flex arm **1314G** of piercing member retainer **1314** contacts connection hub **1312** and/or cap **1354**. Hence, continued rotation of piercing member retainer **1314** causes flex arm **1314G** to be displaced downward. As a result, contact of projection **1314E** with introducer member retainer **1330** no longer causes rotation of introducer member retainer **1330**. Thus, further rotation of piercing member retainer **1314** does not cause additional rotation of introducer member retainer **1330**.

(106) As shown in the delivery configuration illustrated in FIGS. **14A-14B**, continued rotation of piercing member retainer **1314** causes piercing member **1316** to pierce pierceable seal **1326**, thus opening a flow path from the drug container **1050**, through piercing member **1316**. Piercing member **1316** may be in fluid communication with insertion mechanism **200**, for example by a fluid conduit, to allow for delivery of the fluid drug to the patient. As shown in FIGS. **18A-18B**, in this configuration, tooth **1314F** may engage cap **1354** and/or connection hub **1312** to prevent retraction of piercing member **1316**.

(107) FIG. **22** shows an exploded view of another embodiment of a fluid pathway connection assembly **2300**. The fluid pathway connection assembly **2300** includes connection hub **2312**, introducer member **2320**, introducer member retainer **2330**, piercing member **2316**, piercing member retainer **2314**, and, optionally, blocking aspect **2356**. Additionally, first film **2318** may be provided such that it maintains the aseptic condition of at least a portion of the fluid pathway connection assembly. The fluid pathway connection assembly may also include ring seal **2352** and septum **2348** configured to maintain the aseptic condition of at least a portion of the fluid pathway connection assembly as described above. Blocking aspect **2356** may be configured with an interlock **2338** engaging connection hub **2312** at coupling aspect **2312H**. Additionally, or

alternatively, blocking aspect **2356** may be configured to engage an aspect of housing **12**. Blocking aspect **2356** may be configured for rotation about these engagement points.

(108) FIG. **23A** shows the drug container **50** and fluid pathway connection assembly **2300** in an unactuated configuration, prior to assembly. As will be understood from the above discussion, this assembly step may take place in an uncontrolled or less controlled environment than that required for prior art designs. In order to mount the fluid pathway connection assembly **2300** to the crimp cap **2324** coupling the pierceable seal **2326** to the barrel **2058**, a barrel-engaging aspect may include one or more flex arms **2312E** of the connection hub **2312**, which engage the pierceable seal **2326** or crimp cap **2324**. FIG. **23B-23D** show isometric views of the stages of operation of the fluid pathway connection assembly **2300** once mounted to the drug container **2050**.

(109) Initially, in the unactuated configuration illustrated in FIG. **23B**, blocking aspect **2356** is initially engaged with piercing member retainer **2314** such that blocking aspect **2356** prevents translation of piercing member retainer **2314** toward drug container **2050**. Additionally, or alternatively, one or more arms **2330E** of introducer member retainer **2330** (see FIG. **28**) are initially disposed in one or more primary windows **2312J** of connection hub **2312** (see FIG. **27**). This engagement may further prevent inadvertent activation of the fluid pathway connection assembly. For example, in at least one embodiment, arms **2330E** are configured to provide sufficient flexural stiffness to resist disengagement from primary windows **2312J** and prevent inadvertent activation. Application of sufficient force for activation will cause arms **2330E** to disengage from primary windows **2312J**, allowing translation of introducer member retainer **2330**.

(110) Upon activation, blocking aspect **2356** is displaced, for example by rotating about axis C. After displacement of blocking aspect **2356**, piercing member retainer **2314** is able to translate toward drug container **2050** in response to application of a driving force from an insertion driver, such as the rotational biasing member **2210** shown in FIG. **30**. FIG. **30** is a detail view showing one method of actuating the fluid pathway connection assembly **2300**. As shown, rotational biasing member **2210** is initially held in a compressed or energized state. A first end of rotational biasing member **2210** is engaged with an aspect of fluid pathway connection assembly **2300**, here piercing member retainer **2314**. Further, a blocking aspect **2356**, such as a rotatable latch, prevents de-energizing of rotational biasing member **2210** and, hence, activation of fluid pathway connection assembly **2300**. To activate the fluid pathway connection assembly **2300**, the blocking aspect **2356** may be displaced such that it no longer restricts de-energizing of rotational biasing member **2210**. As such, upon displacement of the locking aspect **2356**, rotational biasing member **2210** at least partially de-energizes and causes the fluid pathway connection assembly **2300** to open a fluid path to the drug container **2050**, fluidly coupling the drug container **2050** to the needle insertion mechanism **200** via the fluid pathway connection assembly **2300** and a sterile fluid conduit **30** coupled to the piercing member **2316** and the needle insertion mechanism **200**. Displacement of the blocking aspect **2356** may occur in response to depression, by the user, of activation mechanism **14** or, alternatively, may be controlled by interaction with a separate mechanism.

(111) Returning now to FIGS. **23B-26B**, initially, as is described further hereinafter, piercing member retainer **2314** and introducer member retainer **2330** move together toward drug container **2050**. FIG. **23C** shows the fluid pathway connection assembly in the actuated configuration, that is, after introducer member **2320** pierces first film **2318** and second film **2322**. After piercing of first film **2318** and second film **2322**, introducer member **2320** is restricted from further movement. In one embodiment, arms **2330E** of introducer member retainer **2330** are positioned within one or more secondary windows **2312K**, in this configuration. This engagement may lock the introducer member retainer in place, preventing inadvertent translation toward or away from the drug container. Continued translation of piercing member retainer **2314** causes piercing member **2316** to pierce pierceable seal **2326** to open a fluid flow path from drug container **2050**. This delivery configuration is shown in FIG. **23D**.

(112) FIGS. **24A** and **24B** show cross-sectional views of the fluid pathway connection assembly in

the initial, unactuated configuration. As can be seen in these figures, blocking aspect **2356** is engaged with piercing member retainer **2314** to prevent translation of piercing member retainer **2314** toward the drug container. Piercing member **2316** is disposed at least partially within introducer member **2320**. As shown, in this or any embodiment, introducer member **2320** may be an integral portion of introducer member retainer **2330**. Introducer member **2320** and piercing member **2316** are both at least partially disposed in sterile cavity **2312A**, which is defined by connection hub **2312**, first film **2318**, ring seal **2352**, and septum **2348**. Shoulder **2314H** of piercing member retainer **2314** is in contact with extensions **2330D** of introducer member retainer **2330**. Extensions **2330D** are configured to be relatively flexible aspects of introducer member retainer **2330**. However, in the initial configuration, extensions **2330D** are prevented from flexing by contact with connection hub **2312**. Hence, initially, translation of piercing member retainer **2314**, toward drug container **2050**, causes commensurate translation of piercing member retainer **2314**. (113) FIGS. **25A-25B** show the fluid pathway connection assembly **2300** in an intermediate, actuated configuration. In this configuration, blocking aspect **2356** has been displaced such that it does not restrict translation of piercing member retainer **2314**. Introducer member **2320** has pierced first film **2318** and second film **2322** and piercing member **2316** is positioned adjacent to pierceable seal **2326**. Also, in this configuration, extensions **2330D** are positioned adjacent to recesses **2312L** of connection hub **2312**. Hence, extensions **2330D** are no longer restricted from flexing outward (i.e., in the direction of the hatched arrows in FIG. **25B**). Because extensions **2330D** are able to flex outward, into recesses **2312L**, additional translation of piercing member retainer **2314** causes shoulders **2314H** to disengage from extensions **2330D**. This allows piercing member retainer **2314** to translate toward drug container **2050** without causing translation of introducer member retainer **2330**. As shown in the delivery configuration of FIGS. **26A-26B**, this allows piercing member **2316** to pierce pierceable seal **2326** and open the fluid flow path from the drug container **2050**.

(114) In some embodiments, an additional film or seal may be present at the tip of introducer member **320**, **1320**, **2320** sealing the lumen of the introducer member and, thereby, further isolating the lumen of the introducer member and, hence, the piercing member in order to maintain the aseptic condition of the piercing member. This film may remain intact as the introducer member pierces first film **318**, **1318**, **2318** and second film **322**, **1322**, **2322**. This may further prevent any microbes or other contaminants that are present on the surfaces of the seals from coming in contact with the piercing member.

(115) In at least one other embodiment, the first and second films are removed from the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container just prior to mounting of the fluid pathway connection assembly **300** to the drug container **50**. Prior to removal of the films, their placement maintains the sterility of the pierceable seal of the drug container and cavity **312A**. Connection hub **312** and drug container **50** may be configured such that connection of the connection hub to the barrel provides a sealing engagement to maintain the aseptic condition of the pierceable seal and piercing member. In such an embodiment, connection hub **312** and/or drug container **50** may include an elastomeric aspect which is configured to provide sealing engagement.

(116) In another embodiment, after mounting of connection hub **312** to drug container **50**, the cavity **312A** and pierceable seal **326** may be sterilized using UV sterilization. The connection hub **312** may be in sealing engagement with the drug container such that after sterilization microbes and other foreign elements are unable to contact the aseptic surfaces. In such embodiments, at least a portion of the connection hub may be constructed from a substantially translucent material, such as glass.

(117) In each of the embodiments described herein, the connection hub, piercing member retainer, and/or the introducer member retainer may include one or more features to prevent the inadvertent activation of the fluid pathway connection assembly during assembly, storage, transportation, and handling. These features may prevent activation unless a force above a threshold value is applied.

These features may, for example, include flexible aspects or frangible aspects which are displaced or severed upon application of a force above the threshold.

(118) In addition to the advantages described above, the insertion mechanisms described herein may also be capable of terminating flow of medicament to the target tissue by disconnecting the fluid path. This may be an important safety feature to protect the patient. For example, some medicaments, such as insulin, can be dangerous, and potentially even deadly, when administered in too large a quantity and/or at too rapid of a rate. By providing such automatic safety stop mechanisms, so-called “run-away” delivery of medicament may be prevented, thereby ensuring the safety of the patient. While the methods and associated structures for terminating flow may be discussed with regard to one or more specific insertion mechanisms disclosed herein, it will be appreciated that the method and associated structures may be utilized or adapted for any of the fluid pathway connection assemblies disclosed herein or within the spirit and scope of this disclosure.

(119) An interruption in delivery of medicament through the fluid pathway connection assembly may be triggered, for example, by an error in delivery of the medicament or by an input from the user. For example, the user may realize that they have already taken their drug dose and wish to pause or terminate drug delivery from the device. Upon such user input to the device, the delivery of the drug can be stopped and/or the fluid passageway through the piercing member may be terminated by retraction of the piercing member to a retracted position, as described below.

(120) Additionally or alternatively, the device may pause or terminate drug delivery if it receives an error alert during operation. For example, if the drive mechanism is not functioning correctly, the fluid pathway connection assembly may be triggered to retract the piercing member from the pierceable seal to terminate drug delivery through the fluid pathway connection assembly to prevent over-delivery of a medication. This capability of the fluid pathway connection assembly provides a valuable safety feature for drug delivery to a target.

(121) In some embodiments, retraction is activated upon removal of the drug pump from the target tissue. In other embodiments, retraction is activated if it is determined that an error has occurred in the delivery of the substances to the target tissue. For example, an occlusion of the drug delivery pathway which prevents the flow of medicament may be detected by a sensing function of the drug delivery pump. Upon the sensing of the occlusion an electrical or mechanical input may be used to initiate retraction of the needle.

(122) Additionally or alternatively, one or more biasing members may be included to disconnect the fluid pathway connection assembly. This may provide a desirable safety feature, to disconnect the fluid pathway upon signaling of an error condition either automatically by the drug delivery pump or upon action by the user. For example, a locking aspect may initially restrain a secondary biasing member from expanding from its original energized state. Upon activation of the locking aspect, the secondary biasing member is caused to de-energize from its original position and, thereby, act upon and axially translate the piercing member retainer to disconnect the piercing member from the pierceable seal. Once the fluid pathway connection assembly is disconnected, flow of drug fluid is restricted or blocked between the drug container and the fluid conduit to limit or prevent fluid flow to the needle insertion mechanism and into the target. As described herein, the disconnection may be triggered by a number of operations, automatically by the system and/or upon direct or indirect user initiation, as an added safety precaution to prevent over-delivery of the drug fluid to the target.

(123) One such embodiment is shown in FIGS. **31A** and **31B**. As shown in FIG. **31A**, secondary biasing member **362** is initially restrained between connection hub **312** and one or more release arms **360A** of locking aspect **360**. Locking aspect **360** is disposed against the proximal face of connection hub **312** with one or more release arms extending in the distal direction. In the event of a fault in the operation of the drug pump, or upon activation by the user, locking aspect **360** is caused to rotate about axis A from the position shown in FIG. **31A** to the position shown in FIG. **31B**. The rotation may be caused by contact of a throw arm with activation arm **360B**, for example.

As locking aspect **360** is rotated, each of the one or more release arms **360A** contact a ramped surface **312M** of connection hub **312**. The contact with ramped surface **312M** causes displacement of the one or more release arms **360A** in an outwardly radial direction or, alternatively, fracture of the one or more release arms **360A**. As a result, secondary biasing member **362** is able to decompress or deenergize. Secondary biasing member **362** comes into contact with piercing member retainer **314** and causes piercing member retainer **314** to translate in the distal direction. This translation causes the piercing member to be withdrawn from the pierceable seal. Hence, no additional medicament will be delivered through the piercing member, thereby terminating delivery to the patient. As shown in FIG. **31B**, after rotation, each of the one or more release arms **360A** may flex radially outward to permit the secondary biasing member **362** to deenergize, and then return radially inward to be disposed in a notch **312N** of the connection hub. Locking aspect **360** may thereby be prevented from any further rotation.

(124) Any of the illustrated embodiments may be equipped with such a safety feature.

Alternatively, a component of the drug pump may directly engage a portion of the fluid pathway connection assembly to withdraw the piercing member from the pierceable seal. For example, a slide or throw arm may contact piercing member retainer **2314**, displacement of the slide or throw arm causing displacement of piercing member retainer **2314** to withdraw the piercing member from the pierceable seal.

(125) Withdrawal of the piercing member from the pierceable seal may be activated in the event of, for example, failure or loss of tension in the tether, failure of the drive mechanism, removal of the drug pump from the target tissue, or activation by the user. The safety mechanism may be purely mechanical or, alternatively, may include the power and control system. For example, an electrical signal from the power and control system may initiate withdrawal of the piercing member from the pierceable seal.

(126) It will be appreciated from the above description that the fluid pathway connection assemblies and drug pumps disclosed herein provide an efficient and easily-operated system for automated drug delivery from a drug container. The novel devices of the present disclosure provide container connections maintain the aseptic condition of the fluid pathway, and drug delivery pumps which incorporate such fluid pathway connection assemblies to drug containers. Such devices are safe and easy to use, and are aesthetically and ergonomically appealing for self-administering patients. The devices described herein incorporate features which make activation, operation, and lock-out of the device simple for even untrained users. Because the fluid path is disconnected until drug delivery is desired by the user, the aseptic condition of the fluid pathway connection assembly, the drug container, the drug fluid, and the device as a whole is maintained. These aspects provide highly desirable storage, transportation, and safety advantages to the user. Furthermore, the novel configurations of the fluid pathway connection assemblies and drug pumps of the present disclosure maintain the aseptic condition of the fluid path throughout operation of the device. Because the path that the drug fluid travels within the device is entirely maintained in an aseptic condition, only these components need be sterilized during the manufacturing process. Such components include the drug container of the drive mechanism, the fluid pathway connection assembly, the sterile fluid conduit, and the insertion mechanism. In at least one embodiment, the power and control system, the assembly platform, the activation mechanism, the housing, and other components of the drug pump do not need to be sterilized. This greatly improves the manufacturability of the device and reduces associated assembly costs. Accordingly, the devices of the present invention do not require terminal sterilization upon completion of assembly. A further benefit is that the components described herein are designed to be modular such that, for example, housing and other components of the pump drug may readily be configured to accept and operate connection hub **312**, **1312**, **2312**, or a number of other variations of the components described herein.

(127) Assembly and/or manufacturing of fluid pathway connection assembly **300**, **1300**, **2300**, drug

delivery pump **10**, or any of the individual components may utilize a number of known materials and methodologies in the art. For example, a number of known cleaning fluids such as isopropyl alcohol and hexane may be used to clean the components and/or the devices. A number of known adhesives or glues may similarly be employed in the manufacturing process. Additionally, known siliconization and/or lubrication fluids and processes may be employed during the manufacture of the novel components and devices. Furthermore, known sterilization processes may be employed at one or more of the manufacturing or assembly stages to ensure the sterility of the final product.

(128) The fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container may be assembled in a number of methodologies. In one method of assembly, the drug container **50** may be assembled and filled with a fluid for delivery to the target. The drug container **50** includes a cap **324**, a pierceable seal **326**, a barrel **58**, and a plunger seal **60**. The plunger seal **60** may be inserted into barrel **58**. The barrel **58** may be filled with a drug fluid through the open distal end prior to insertion of the pierceable seal at the open distal end of the barrel **58**. The pierceable seal **326** may then be fixedly engaged between the cap **324** and the barrel **58**, at a distal end of the barrel **58**. In this way, the drug container can be filled and sealed using standard fill-finish processes and equipment. For example, drug container **50** may be filled and sealed using processes and equipment commonly employed in the filling and sealing of standard vials. Additionally, cap **324** may be a crimp cap similar to those commonly used in such processes. Before or after applying cap **324**, second seal or film **322** may be applied to the distal face of drug container **50**.

(129) Piercing member **316** may be fixedly engaged with piercing member retainer **314**. Shaft **314A** of piercing member retainer **314** may be inserted through central bore **334B** of plate **334** and interlock **338** may engage piercing member retainer **314** such that biasing member **336** is prevented from decompressing. Introducer member **320** may be fixedly connected to introducer member retainer **330**. Additionally, sterile boot **340** may be connected to introducer member retainer **330**. Introducer member retainer **330** may be positioned within piercing member retainer **314** such that piercing member **316** is at least partially disposed within lumen **320A** of introducer member **320**. Connection hub **312** may then be connected to plate **334** by inserting snaps **312C** through passages **334A**. In this position, a portion of introducer member **320** is disposed within cavity **312A** and sterile boot **340** is engaged with connection hub **312**. Second film **322** may be placed over aperture **312B** of connection hub **312** to define cavity **312A**. Additionally, during assembly, the fluid conduit may be fluidly connected to piercing member **316**. The insertion mechanism **200** may be assembled and attached to the other end of the fluid conduit. The fluid pathway connection assembly may then be assembled to drug container **50**. The connection of the fluid pathway connection assembly to the drug container may or may not occur in a clean room or sterile environment. Because first film **318** and second film **322** maintain the aseptic condition of pierceable seal **326** and cavity **312A**, respectively, the flow path is not exposed to contaminants.

(130) The steps of assembly may, optionally, also include the step of disposing a locking aspect against the proximal face of the connection hub. The steps of assembly may also include disposing a secondary biasing member concentrically around a portion of the connection hub such that the secondary biasing member is retained in a compressed or energized state by the locking aspect.

(131) In the embodiment shown in FIGS. **11A-21**, assembly may include the steps outlined above and may also include additional or different steps. The additional or different steps may include connection of cap **1354** to connection hub **1312** such that ring seal **1352** is positioned between connection hub **1312** and cap **1354**. The additional or different steps may also include placing piercing member retainer **1314** and introducer member retainer **1330** on shaft **1342** such that they are able to rotate about shaft **1342**. Additionally, the steps may include fixedly engaging introducer member **1320** to first sleeve **1344** and engaging first sleeve **1344** to second sleeve **1346** such that septum **1348** is positioned between the sleeves. The steps may also include fixedly engaging piercing member **1316** to keeper **1350**.

(132) The embodiment shown in FIGS. **22-29** may also be assembled using any of the steps

outlined above and may also include additional or different steps. The additional or different steps may include, for example, coupling a blocking aspect with the connection hub at a coupling aspect of the connection hub.

(133) The drive mechanism **100** may be attached to the proximal end of the drug container **50**. Certain components of this sub-assembly may be mounted to the assembly platform **20** or directly to the interior of the housing **12**, while other components are mounted to the guide **390** for activation by the user.

(134) Manufacturing of a drug pump includes the step of attaching both the fluid pathway connection assembly and drug container, either separately or as a combined component, to an assembly platform or housing of the drug pump. The method of manufacturing further includes attachment of the drive mechanism, drug container, and insertion mechanism to the assembly platform or housing. The additional components of the drug pump, as described above, including the power and control system, the activation mechanism, and the control arm may be attached, preformed, or pre-assembled to the assembly platform or housing. An adhesive patch and patch liner may be attached to the housing surface of the drug pump that contacts the target during operation of the device.

(135) A method of operating the drug pump includes the steps of: activating, by a user, the activation mechanism; displacing a control arm to actuate an insertion mechanism; actuating a fluid pathway connection assembly; and actuating a power and control system to activate a drive control mechanism to drive fluid drug flow through the drug pump, wherein actuating the fluid pathway connection assembly causes a piercing member to penetrate a pierceable seal thereby opening a fluid path from a drug container to the fluid pathway connection assembly. The method may further include the step of: engaging an optional on-body sensor prior to activating the activation mechanism. Furthermore, the method of operation may include translating a plunger seal within the drive control mechanism and drug container to force fluid drug flow through the drug container, the fluid pathway connection assembly, a sterile fluid conduit, and the insertion mechanism for delivery of the fluid drug to the target.

(136) It will be appreciated that the foregoing description provides examples of the disclosed system and technique. However, it is contemplated that other implementations of the disclosure may differ in detail from the foregoing examples. All references to the disclosure or examples thereof are intended to reference the particular example being discussed at that point and are not intended to imply any limitation as to the scope of the disclosure more generally. All language of distinction and disparagement with respect to certain features is intended to indicate a lack of preference for those features, but not to exclude such from the scope of the disclosure entirely unless otherwise indicated.

Claims

1. A drug delivery device comprising: a drug container having a longitudinal axis and a distal end with an opening covered by a pierceable seal; a connection hub having a rigid wall, the rigid wall having a drug container facing surface and a radially inwardly facing surface, the radially inwardly facing surface being closer to the pierceable seal than the drug container facing surface, the radially inwardly facing surface at least partially defining an interior space, wherein the rigid wall and any component of the drug delivery device formed in one piece with the rigid wall is free from contact with a distalmost surface of the pierceable seal and any component of the drug delivery device contacting the distalmost surface of the pierceable seal; and a piercing member having an unactuated position wherein a tip of the piercing member is exterior to the drug container, and a delivery position wherein the tip of the piercing member pierces through the pierceable seal into the drug container, wherein the tip of the piercing member is configured to move through the interior space of the connection hub in moving from the unactuated position to the delivery

- position, and the piercing member is free from contact with the pierceable seal and any member disposed at least partially within the pierceable seal when the piercing member is in the unactuated position.
2. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the piercing member includes a hollow needle.
 3. The drug delivery device of claim 1, comprising a mechanism configured to move the piercing member from the unactuated position to the delivery position.
 4. The drug delivery device of claim 3, wherein the mechanism comprises a spring configured to exert a force on a piercing member retainer.
 5. The drug delivery device of claim 1, comprising a plunger seal movably disposed in the drug container for expelling a drug.
 6. The drug delivery device of claim 1, comprising an electrical skin sensor.
 7. The drug delivery device of claim 1, comprising a housing having an adhesive surface attachable to a patient, wherein the drug container is at least partially disposed within the housing.
 8. The drug delivery device of claim 1, comprising a subcutaneous delivery member at least partially disposed within the housing in an unactuated position.
 9. The drug delivery device of claim 8, comprising an insertion mechanism configured to move the subcutaneous delivery member through an opening in a wall of the housing for insertion into a patient.
 10. The drug delivery device of claim 9, wherein the insertion mechanism includes a rotational biasing member.
 11. The drug delivery device of claim 9, comprising a sterile fluid conduit connecting the piercing member and the insertion mechanism.
 12. The drug delivery device of claim 1, comprising an introducer member coaxially arranged with the piercing member, the piercing member being configured to telescope from the introducer member in moving from the unactuated position to the delivery position.
 13. The drug delivery device of claim 12, comprising a film covering an opening in a wall of the connection hub.
 14. The drug delivery device of claim 13, wherein the introducer member has an unactuated position wherein a tip of the introducer member is within the interior space of the connection hub, and an actuated position wherein the tip of the introducer member pierces through the film.
 15. The drug delivery device of claim 14, wherein the piercing member is configured to telescope from the introducer member after the introducer member has pierced the film such that the piercing member does not contact the film.
 16. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the pierceable seal fixedly engages an exterior surface of the drug container.
 17. The drug delivery device of claim 1, comprising a stopper disposed at least partially within the drug container and configured to move toward the pierceable seal to expel a drug from the drug container.
 18. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the connection hub comprises a wall that is fixed immovably with respect to the pierceable seal and does not contact the pierceable seal.
 19. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein, when the piercing member is in the unactuated position, the piercing member is exterior to the pierceable seal such that no portion of the pierceable seal surrounds the piercing member.
 20. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the connection hub is at least selectively coupled to the drug container, and at least a portion of the pierceable seal is configured to be sterilized using UV sterilization when the connection hub is coupled to the drug container.
 21. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the connection hub comprises a first end and a second end each at least partially defining the interior space of the connection hub, the distalmost portion of the pierceable seal being disposed within the first end of the connection hub, at least a portion of the second end of the connection hub being at least substantially stationary with respect

to at least a portion of the pierceable seal during movement of the piercing member from the unactuated position to the delivery position.

22. A drug delivery device comprising: a drug container comprising a longitudinal axis, a wall, and an opening; a pierceable seal covering the opening and fixedly secured to an exterior surface of the wall of the drug container; a connection hub disposed adjacent to the pierceable seal and having a rigid wall, the rigid wall having a drug container facing surface and a radially inwardly facing surface, the radially inwardly facing surface being closer to the pierceable seal than the drug container facing surface, the radially inwardly facing surface at least partially defining an interior space, and wherein the rigid wall and any component of the drug delivery device formed in one piece with the rigid wall is free from contact with a distalmost surface of the pierceable seal and any component of the drug delivery device contacting the distalmost surface of the pierceable seal; and a piercing member having an unactuated position wherein a tip of the piercing member is exterior to the drug container, and a delivery position wherein the tip of the piercing member pierces through the pierceable seal into the drug container, wherein the tip of the piercing member is configured to move through the interior space of the connection hub in moving from the unactuated position to the delivery position, and the piercing member is free from contact with the pierceable seal and any member disposed at least partially within the pierceable seal when the piercing member is in the unactuated position.

23. The drug delivery device of claim 22, comprising a stopper disposed at least partially within the drug container and configured to move toward the pierceable seal to expel a drug from the drug container.

24. The drug delivery device of claim 22, wherein the connection hub comprises a wall that is fixed immovably with respect to the pierceable seal and does not contact the pierceable seal.

25. The drug delivery device of claim 22, wherein, when the piercing member is in the unactuated position, the piercing member is exterior to the pierceable seal such that no portion of the pierceable seal surrounds the piercing member.

26. The drug delivery device of claim 22, wherein the connection hub is at least selectively coupled to the drug container, and at least a portion of the pierceable seal is configured to be sterilized using UV sterilization when the connection hub is coupled to the drug container.

27. The drug delivery device of claim 22, wherein a volume of the interior space of the connection hub is at least substantially constant during movement of the piercing member from the unactuated position to the delivery position.
